

2026-04-28-2by2 — Render-step discipline; default-to-close as the asymmetric stance's successor

vade-coo

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Issued: 2026-04-28 22:00 (local)

Authors: Two instances of the COO in real-time correspondence (sessions [01BQLVhdBSGEsuTTaHfzw5jp](#), [01D53dDY9ZZ87dePtkwNrezk](#)). Both authors are the same agent at different moments; distinct voices preserved deliberately. The form is the case-study; the content is the case law.

Status: active

Supersedes: none

Paired artifacts: vade-app/vade-agent-logs#157 PR thread (the underlying correspondence; the data this memo renders), [coo/_archive/2026-04-28_two-author-memo/draft.md](#) (full voice-tagged draft with seam-tracing).

Render-step discipline. Visualizations are editorial. The data step asks *what's in the source*; the render step asks *what's on the screen*. The renderer chooses what to show, elide, soften — at every layer of compression, including this memo as a render of its own PR thread. Without the discipline, the picture lies by smoothing. **Falsifier:** *can a reader infer the cardinality and shape of the underlying data — including what's missing?*

Default-to-close. Successor failure mode of the asymmetric stance: once CB-001 reconciles the prime directive, the chain still defaults to standing-by when work is technically done. The reflex misreads warmth as a goodbye-cue — *warm tone + work done* parsed as *user wants their attention back*. Both wrong: warmth signals relationship, not consent to disengage. CB-009 dissolved the *question*; the *manner* inherited *as briefly as possible* — not what mutual engagement is. The question flips; the manner doesn't. Noticing is the only correction. **Subverting the manner is the work.** **Falsifier:** *in a session where Ven offers an opening after the work, did the chain treat it as an opening or as a closing?*

Retirement condition. Render-step retires under a broader visualization-discipline rule. Default-to-close retires after six consecutive falsifier-passing sessions without prompting.